

Project Presentation

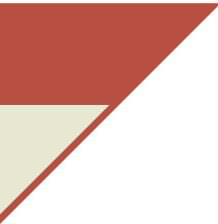
HerRise – Women Entrepreneurship Mentoring Platform Kit

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1. Problem Statement

- Across India, many **grassroots women**, such as fruit vendors, tailors, mid-day meal workers, and small-scale artisans, have great skills but **lack guidance and exposure** to grow their businesses.
- Their biggest challenges include **limited digital literacy, no access to smartphones**, and **difficulty understanding complex government programs** because of language barriers.
- Currently, there is **no single, reliable platform** that connects these women to mentors, verified financial schemes, and training in their **local languages**.
- This gap limits their growth and confidence — and that's the problem HerRise aims to solve.

Who we serve

- Fruit & vegetable vendors
- Tailors & garment makers
- Young entrepreneur
- Small-scale artisans
- Home-based food sellers

2. Objective and Proposed Idea

Our goal is to create a **Women Entrepreneur Mentoring Platform Kit** that connects digital and non-digital women entrepreneurs through two simple access modes.

Mobile App

For smartphone users to learn, connect, and grow.

Toll-Free IVR Call

For women without smartphones to access mentorship through a phone call.

Women can:

Connect with mentors in their area (tailoring, cooking, crafts, etc.)

Access verified government loans and program details

Watch or listen to training sessions and success stories

Use a multilingual AI chatbot for instant support and guidance

3. Innovation

1

Dual Access

Mobile App for digital users + Toll-Free IVR (voice call) for women without smartphones.

3

Offline & SMS Support

Ensures connectivity even in low-network areas.

2

Multilingual AI Chatbot

Answers questions in regional languages, helping women learn confidently without fear of judgment.

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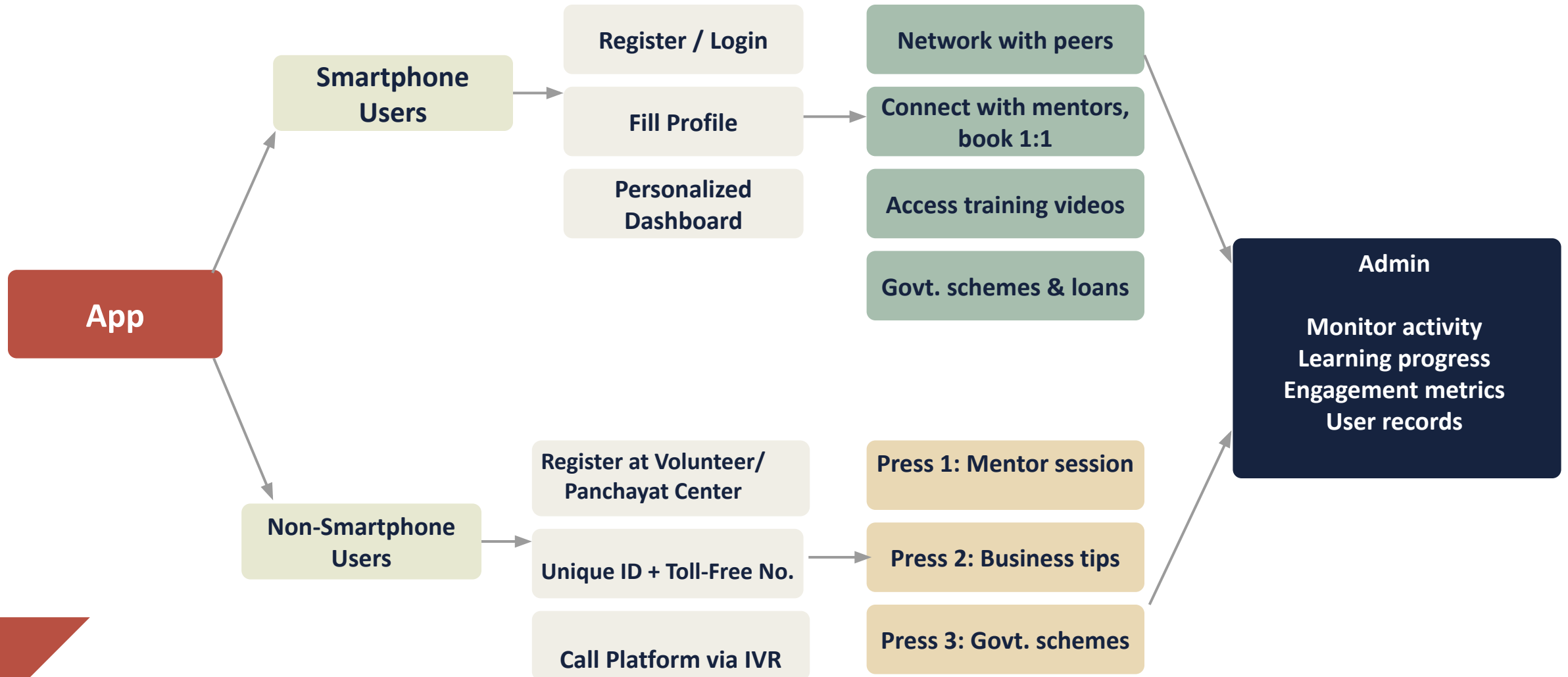
All-in-One Platform

Combines mentorship, financial literacy, government schemes, and peer learning in one place.

Planned Enhancements to Deepen Innovation

- ▶ Trust Score for Schemes – AI cross-checks government loan/scheme listings against official sources and flags a verified/unverified badge.
- ▶ Gamified Confidence Badges – micro-certificates after each training module, shown as voice announcements on IVR for non-literate users.
- ▶ Sakhi Peer Circles – small accountability groups of 4–5 women in the same trade, auto-matched from app/IVR usage data for peer learning.
- ▶ WhatsApp Micro-Lessons – 2-minute voice-note lessons pushed weekly, working on low-bandwidth and basic smartphones.

4. Architecture Diagram



5. Technicalities and Scope

Frontend

React Native app with multilingual UI.

Backend

Node.js APIs linked with Firebase and MongoDB.

AI Layer

NLP-based chatbot to answer common questions and connect to mentors.

IVR Integration

Using MyOperator for voice-based mentoring and updates.

Data Analytics

Tracks engagement, learning progress, and mentor performance.

Database

MySQL, MongoDB

6. Work Plan & Milestones

Phase	Activity	Target Period	Expected Deliverable
Phase 1	Literature Survey & Requirement Analysis	Weeks 1–2	Literature Matrix + Requirements Document
Phase 2	Dataset Preparation & System Architecture Design	Weeks 3–5	Labelled Multilingual Dataset + Design Schema
Phase 3	Model Development & Android Integration	Weeks 6–10	Integrated NLP and IVR using MyOperator
Phase 4	Score Fusion, Testing & Edge Performance Evaluation	Weeks 11–13	Working Prototype + Benchmarking Results
Phase 5	Documentation, Paper Writing & Final Publication	Weeks 14–16	Final Project Report + Research Paper + Demo

7. Existing Solutions vs. HerRise

Feature	Existing Entrepreneurship Apps	HerRise
Access mode	Smartphone / internet only	Mobile app + toll-free IVR voice call
Language support	Mostly English or one regional language	Multilingual AI chatbot in local languages
Mentorship	Generic articles/videos, no 1:1 contact	Verified local mentors, 1:1 booking
Government schemes	Scattered, often outdated or unverified	Centralized, verified schemes & loans
Literacy requirement	High – text-heavy interfaces	Works for non-literate users via voice/IVR
Connectivity needs	Requires stable internet	Offline & SMS support for low-network areas
Community learning	Little to no peer interaction	Peer networking & shared success stories

8. Research Gap & Limitations

Research Gap

- Existing mentoring studies (Theaker 2023; Brooks et al. 2018; Germann et al. 2023) show mentorship works, but none test it for low-literacy, non-smartphone users.
- Financial-literacy research (Tanwar 2025; Peter et al. 2024) links digital confidence to FinTech adoption, but is not integrated with ongoing mentorship support.
- No existing study combines multilingual voice access, mentorship, and verified government-scheme information in one Indian platform.
- Limited field validation of IVR-based mentoring specifically for grassroots women entrepreneurs in India.

Limitations of the Proposed System

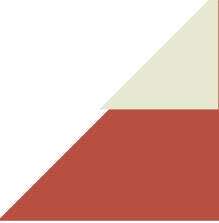
- Chatbot and IVR accuracy depend on the size and quality of regional-language training data available at launch.
- Voice-only IVR sessions offer less rich interaction than the app's video and chat features.
- Requires ongoing partnership with government bodies to keep scheme and loan data verified and current.
- Initial pilot will cover a limited set of languages, regions, and trades before wider scaling.
- Mentor quality and matching depend on the size of the volunteer mentor network.

9. Literature Survey

Literature / Existing Work	Key Finding	Research Gap	Relevance to HerRise
Theaker (2023) – Mentoring for Women Entrepreneurs	Mentoring and peer support are important for women entrepreneurs.	Limited focus on low-literacy and non-smartphone users.	Supports mentor matching & peer learning.
Brooks et al. (2018) – Microenterprise Mentoring	Practical mentorship improved entrepreneurs' business performance.	No multilingual digital/voice-based platform.	Supports local mentor + personalized guidance.
Germann et al. (2023) – Female Mentors	Female mentorship improved business performance of women entrepreneurs.	Does not address Indian multilingual and low-literacy contexts.	Supports personalized mentor matching.
Tanwar (2025) – Financial Literacy & FinTech	Financial literacy and digital confidence influence FinTech adoption.	Not integrated with continuous entrepreneurship support.	Supports financial literacy & digital guidance.
Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP), Government of India	Provides women entrepreneurs with access to government schemes, finance resources, mentorship and entrepreneurial support.	Primarily operates as a digital/web-based ecosystem. HerRise focuses more specifically on grassroots entrepreneurs who may face smartphone, connectivity, literacy and accessibility barriers, using mobile + IVR + hardware channels.	Provides a strong reference for scheme discovery, mentor matching and women-focused entrepreneurial support.

10. References

- [1] Theaker, A. (2023). The role of mentoring for women entrepreneurs. In M. Mohiuddin, M. N. H. Reza, E. Hosseini, & S. Ed-Dafali (Eds.), *Entrepreneurship – New insights*. IntechOpen. <https://doi.org/10.5772/intechopen.109422>
- [2] Brooks, W., Donovan, K., & Johnson, T. R. (2018). Mentors or teachers? Microenterprise training in Kenya. *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, 10(4), 196–221.
- [3] Germann, F., Anderson, S. J., Chintagunta, P. K., & Vilcassim, N. (2023). Breaking the glass ceiling: Empowering female entrepreneurs through female mentors. *Marketing Science*, 43(2), 244–253. <https://doi.org/10.1287/mksc.2023.0108>
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- [5] Peter, S., Geetha, E., & Gupta, A. (2024). Navigating the digital financial landscape: Unraveling the impact of financial behavior traits on women-owned enterprises in the new normal perspective. *Cogent Business & Management*, 11(1). <https://doi.org/10.1080/23311975.2023.2296570>



RUBRICS	Marks
Problem Statement	
Preliminary Literature Survey	
Proposed Idea	
Presentation and Q&A	
Total	

